include those warning lines in French and Russian, or an abbreviated version in German that reads simply *Achtung!*[41] Over the course of Tajiri's project, the clear emphasis and repetition of the allied sector signs refuse to affirm the geopolitical layout of Berlin as logical landmarks. They become staggered question marks for Tajiri, to ponder as a possible element of the wall system or a reminder of this Cold War American frontier.



FIGURE 3.4 Shinkichi Tajiri, *The Berlin Wall, 1969–1970*. (Shinkichi Tajiri Estate)

Tajiri encounters the first of these American sector signs outside the Waltersdorfer Chaussee crossing point, near his opening images (fig. 3.4). Taken from the middle of the street, the image shows a juxtaposition of messages: one sign announcing the end of the American sector and the other marking the beginning of the Soviet sector. Subsequently, in other takes close by, the signs are viewed from their side or from fifty feet away. In each case, the Waltersdorfer Chaussee checkpoint is viewable, with its low white dividers and mazelike routing system. No signs of border guards or imminent danger are immediately clear. Tajiri evidently sees more holes in the Wall, again, behind the signs and at the top of the Wall, beyond which he